

More About Windows

Windows are important parts of all Graphical User Interface. (Microsoft even named their entire user interface system Windows!) A window represents a view into a document. A document is any collection of data you're working with—for example, the first chapter of the Great American Novel, or your quarterly report, or the spiffy new drawing you're working on for the cover of the next Weird Al Yankovic album.

A view is just a way of looking at your document. For example, if you're working with a picture in a paint program, the program probably allows you to work with the document at various magnifications—those are your views. Some programs only have one view, but many let you look at your data in more than one format. Since you might not be able to see the whole document on the screen at once (that is, it might be larger than the screen), you can usually scroll the document to view to different parts of it. Windows provide a way of manipulating your views and keeping track of all the documents you have open.

As usual, we'll use a Finder window to illustrate our discussion. In Figure 5L you'll see a couple of windows called "Q1" and "Q2." (They're from one of our Q Drives.) It's not only possible to have more than one window open, it's actually pretty common—the Finder, for example, lets you open twelve windows at once.

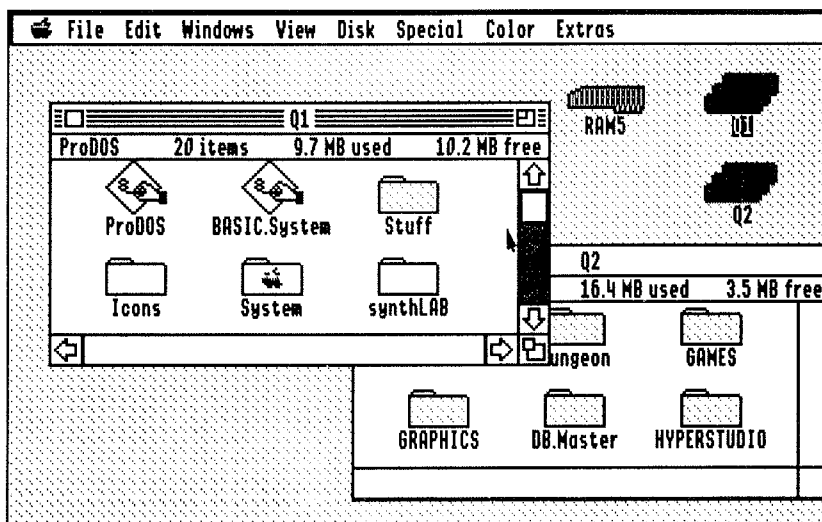


Figure 5L—Sample Windows (from Finder)